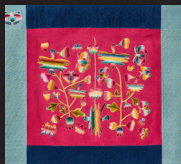


my love



MARRIAGE AND LOVE THROUGH THE EYES OF FEMALE ARTISTS IN KOREA AND JORDAN





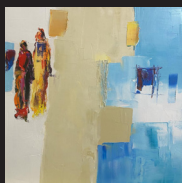
Park In-sook



Chung Hee-Kyung

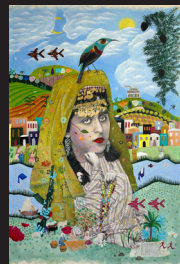
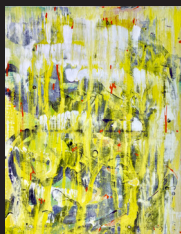


An Se-eun



Rana Safadi

Huh Jeong-won



Dana Barqawi

my love

MARRIAGE AND LOVE THROUGH THE EYES
OF FEMALE ARTISTS IN KOREA AND JORDAN

28 May 2024 - 14 June 2024

An Se-eun
ARTIST, CURATOR



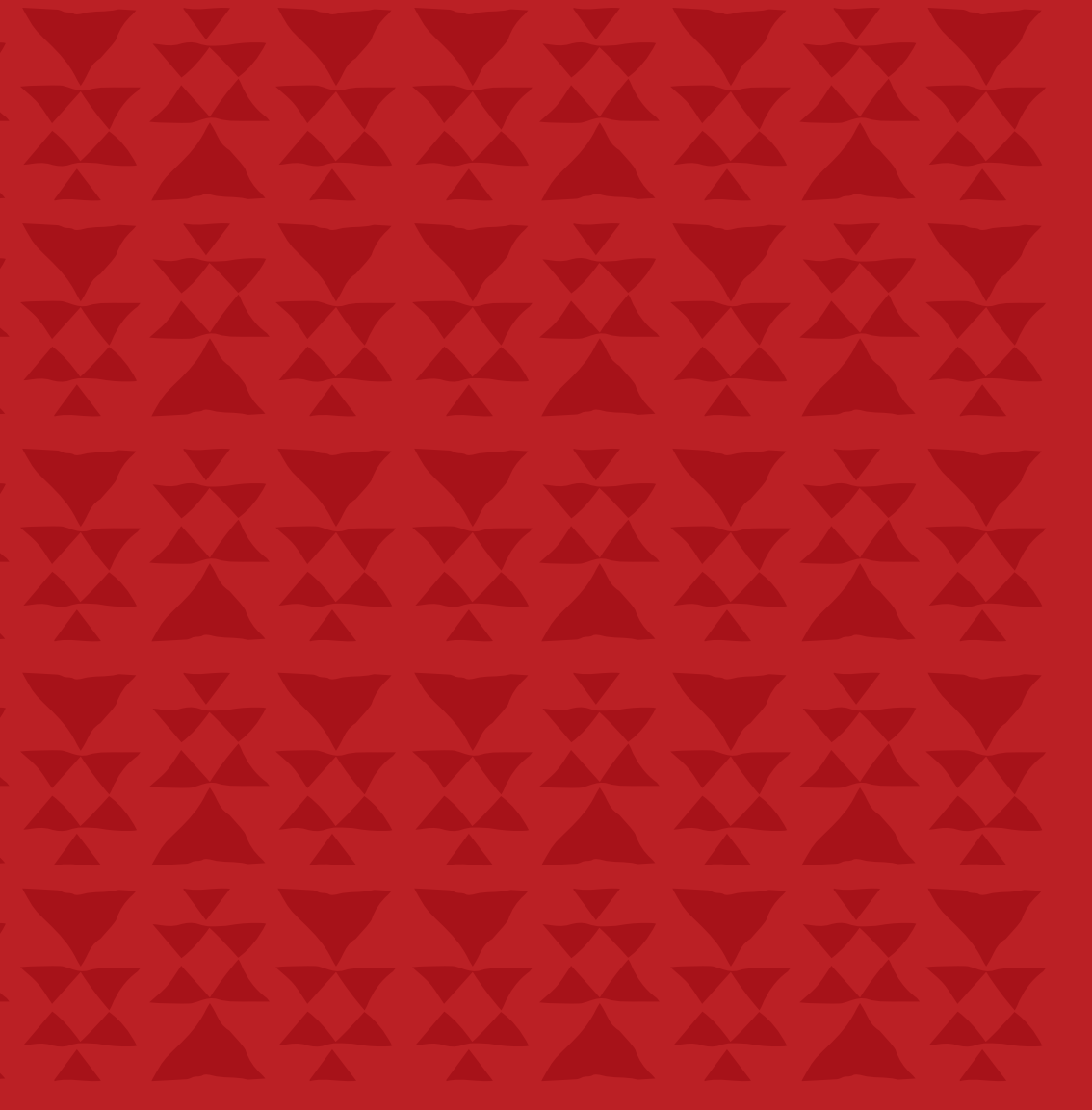
KOREA AND JORDAN are geographically located on opposite ends of Asia. This distance between the countries resulted in different natural environments and distinct religions and cultures. Despite Korea and Jordan being historically agricultural and nomadic societies, respectively, the women of these countries have endured life in surprisingly similar ways. By following in their footsteps, we reflect on our present reality and observe the lives of women in Korea and Jordan who have diligently supported their families and communities despite the socio-economic challenges faced by women in traditional societies.

This exhibition is titled *al Hub* الحب for ‘My Love.’ It showcases the costumes and jewellery used in traditional weddings in Korea and Jordan, alongside the works of contemporary female artists and displays that honour the legacy of those from the past who sewed and embroidered. The exhibition aims to reflect on the significance of a wedding—an important ritual that arguably marks a major turning point in a woman’s life— and the role women play as the protagonists of a special day rather than as passive subjects.

The traditional wedding dresses of Korea and Jordan not only display the highest standard of production and embody great significance in costume history but also serve as a channel for cultural exchange, introducing the heritage of both countries. The exhibition, themed around understanding women’s love, goes beyond displaying historical artefacts. By presenting works of contemporary artists, the exhibition endeavours to understand love through the sublimation of tradition and expands the meaning of love through modern interpretations of tradition. Through this approach, the diverse activities of modern women are narrated, and love from a new perspective is explored.

Beyond comparing the Middle East and the Far East, the past and the present, and Arab and Confucian cultures, the exhibition will be a time to share love through the eyes of women navigating today’s realities.

Salua Qidan
CREATIVE DIRECTOR
TIRAZ CENTRE



IN 2022, Mrs. An invited Mrs. Widad Kawar and myself to her home for a South Korean Heritage Day. We admired the intricate needlework on shiny, colourful silk fabrics in South Korean traditional attire. The work seemed to contrast strongly with the simpler yet unique striped arrangements of cotton embroidery on cotton fabrics of Jordanian heritage dresses. Upon reflecting on this contrast, the idea of holding a joint Korean-Jordanian heritage exhibition occurred to us immediately. The thought has been brewing in our minds for years. I am delighted that it has finally taken form in this exhibition, which expresses a love of tradition while exploring the traditions of expressing love in the context of wedding rituals across our two cultures.

As citizens of Jordan, it is very difficult to think about wedding rituals during this time of war on the other side of the Jordan River. How can we speak about love and dresses when Gaza and Palestine are going through this dark time? When an entire population is denied all basic human rights, speaking about beauty, craftsmanship, and the rituals of wedding preparations seems to be an alien concept.

But there is a different perspective: precisely because our traditions and crafts have been in danger of erasure by wars, displacement, and other factors, we must use every opportunity to preserve our heritage, practice our crafts, create contemporary work inspired by our heritage and way of life, and share it widely. We choose to display the Salt dress, the *Khalaqa*, with all its accessories as our central exhibit. The Salt dress, 3.30 meters long, is considered the longest traditional dress in the world. This ‘pocket *thob ubb*’ — a dress worn by being folded numerous times—is an example of a unique tradition in central Jordan and the Jordan Valley. This type of dress may feature light embroidery on the chest, sleeves, hem, and other parts. Notable examples include the traditional dresses of Salt (*Khalaga*) and the Bani Hassan tribe.

Alongside the traditional attire, we chose to display the work of contemporary Jordanian artists whose work carries the spirit of social and cultural engagement.



Kim Kyungsil

1 Noui was used as a wedding costume for princesses and the royal family. Princess Cheongyeon's Noui has open sides with a hem that is shorter at the front and longer at the back.

Kim Kyungsil is an associate professor at Sungkyunkwan University's Department of Fashion Design. The artist is an apprentice to the Sewing Master (Chimseonjang) Park Gwanghun, who was designated by Seoul City as the Intangible Cultural Heritage No.11.

She is currently working as a board member of the Korean Royal Costume Research Institute and The Korean Society of Fashion Design.



2

2 The 'Gangneung Su Bojagi (embroidered wrapping cloth)', which has been used throughout history as a wedding cloth, is highly appreciated as fabric art both domestically and internationally for its abstractness and modern edge. With its unique and beautiful lines and colors, the embroidered Bojagi has been used as a wrapping cloth for wedding gifts exchanged by the bride and groom.

Park Insook

Park Insook, a handcraft artist based on Gangneung City, leads the 'Imyeong Bojagi Study Group' and promotes the beauty of Gangneung's boudoir craft. She participated in the development of craft souvenirs for the Pyeongchang Cultural Olympiad.

Kim Hisu

Korean traditional Mae-deup artisan Kim Hisu learned from Kim Eun-Young, who is designated as the 'National Intangible Cultural Heritage' of Mae-deup. She is committed to spreading Korean knot art, Mae-deup around the world and sharing the beauty of Korean cultural traditions.

3 Embroidered Norigae with five-colored strawberry-shaped tassel (with Bat-shaped embroidery)



Me for you, You for me
30x30cm, Acrylic on Canvas

An Se-eun

An Se-eun believes that love is a process of filling in gaps and fitting together ambiguities, and portrays such a process in all our relationships through her work.



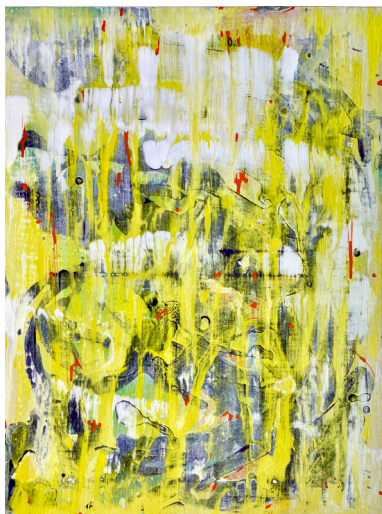
Jour de mariage
20x15cm, Mezzotint

Chung Hee-Kyung

Chung Hee-Kyung, through a delicate mezzotint process, depicts a sky filled with puffy clouds above a bride wearing a Jokduri (a veil worn by the bride at a traditional Korean wedding). It is intended to bless the bride for her marriage.



Diary (Today) detail
Acrylic on Paper



Layers of Love
53x45.5cm, Acrylic, Oil on Canvas

Han Myungok

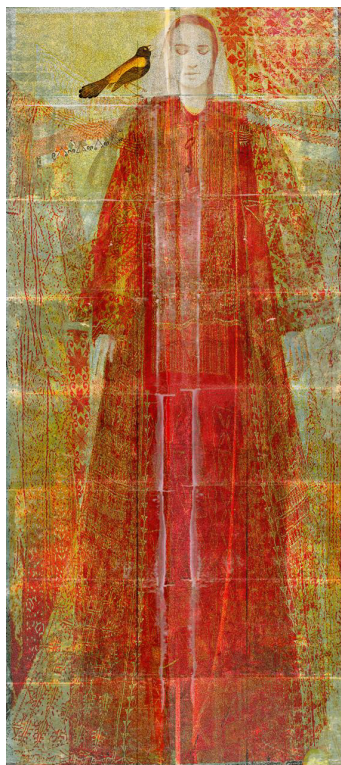
Han Myungok's *Diary(Today)* is based on her writings during the hundred days she spent alongside her husband in a deserted countryside. The work contains the phrases "Today it was windy. Today I feel good. Today I am lonely." and so on, which encompasses all the different feelings experienced by the artist. She believes that momentary emotions and experiences define life and love.

Huh Jeong-won

Huh Jeong-won considers that love, like nature, which embodies the cycle of life and death, creates, dissolves, leaves traces, and dissipates. She expresses this energy through repeated acts of dissolution, collision, permeation, creation, and annihilation.



She is bored of his white colonial lies
100x140cm, Acrylic, oil, thread,
goldleaf on canvas



The Wedding of Gaza II
89x178cm, Composite Photography

Dana Barqawi

*Love is Land, Love is being
rooted, Love is seeing the truth,
Love is Revolution*

Dana Barqawi is a multidisciplinary artist and urban planner whose work reflects the local context, resulting in politically and socially engaged art. Dana's work challenges colonial narratives, explores indigenous identities, and aspects of womanhood and community.

Eman Haram

للحب مسالك ومقامات، اسرارها
كامنة في بقعة في قلب العالم
تسمى فلسطين

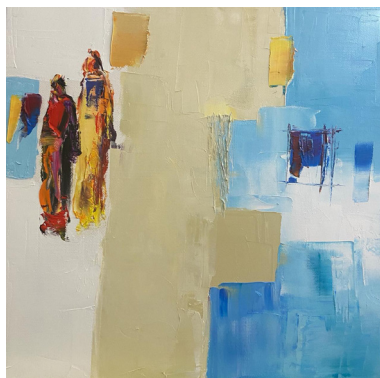
Reflecting on the bruised motherland as a poetic condition with infinite and inexhaustible geographies, liberates it with every reading from the colonizer's cruel and interminable siege.



Food, Love, and Tradition
39x174cm, Textile art

Shereen Quttaineh

In my artwork, I explore the deep bond between food, love, and tradition, focusing on Jordanian weddings. Before catering services, wedding feasts reflected familial heritage and regional influences, revealing the enduring connection between food, love, and cultural identity. Reflecting on the past, I emphasize the intimate link between love and food in these celebratory traditions.



Path to Love Series
40x40cm, Oil on Canvas



Rana A. Safadi

Love, Love, Love...when you surround yourself with light & love, it is the best way to be free. Love is the energy of beauty, depth & passion"

Rana A. Safadi is an artist and cultural consultant who is specialized in cultural and art experiences and tours in Jordan. She is intimately acquainted with Amman's rich history, diverse cultures and contemporary geography and dynamics.



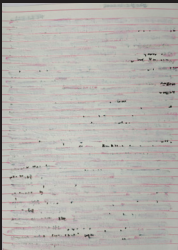
The Salt dress *al Khalaga*, 3.30 meters in length, is considered the longest traditional dress in the world. This 'pocket *thob ubb*' – a dress worn by being folded numerous times – is an example of a unique tradition in central Jordan and the Jordan Valley. Notable examples include the traditional dresses of Al-Salt and the Bani Hassan tribe.



Kim Kyung-sil



Kim Hisu



Han Myungok



Shereen Quttaineh



Eman Haram



Embassy of the
Republic of Korea to
the Hashemite Kingdom
of Jordan



TIRAZ widad kawar
home for arab dress